Square indices and remainders modulo 4 in a theta-type series

A proof of the conjecture in OEIS A380060

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Abstract

The OEIS entry A380060, contributed by Paul D. Hanna, defines a power series $A(x) = 1 + 2x + 4x^2 + 16x^3 + 66x^4 + \cdots$ by an implicit equation: A equals a sum over all integers n whose n-th term is $x^{n^2}\big((A - x^n)/(1 - x^n A)\big)^n$, so A appears on both sides. The sum resembles the classical theta series $\theta(x) = \sum_n x^{n^2} = 1 + 2x + 2x^4 + 2x^9 + \cdots$. Hanna conjectured that, for $n > 0$, the coefficient $a(n)$ leaves remainder 2 on division by 4 when n is a perfect square, and is divisible by 4 otherwise. We prove this. In fact $A(x) \equiv \theta(x) \pmod 4$: every coefficient of A has the same remainder modulo 4 as the corresponding coefficient of the theta series. The proof rests on two simple observations: modulo 2 the series A is just 1, and twice a number is known modulo 4 once the number is known modulo 2. The result has also been checked by computer and proved formally in the Lean proof assistant.

How this paper was produced. This paper reports the result of an autonomous AI research effort. ChatGPT (OpenAI), using the GPT-6 model with Pro reasoning and working from prompts by Dev D. Goyal, found the proof, wrote its Lean 4 formalization, and wrote a first draft of the paper. Dev D. Goyal chose the problems and asked for checks and revisions, but did not supply proof ideas. Claude Opus 5.5, used with Claude Code, then checked the work independently: it rebuilt the formal proofs from source and confirmed that they rely on no unproved assumptions, recomputed the sequence from its definition and tested every claim against the published data, and read every step of the proofs. It also rewrote this paper for clarity. Dev D. Goyal has verified the results and is responsible for them. The paper has not been peer reviewed. The section "About this paper" at the end gives the details.

1 Introduction

1.1 The sequence

The *On-Line Encyclopedia of Integer Sequences* (OEIS) [4] is a large public database of integer sequences, used by mathematicians and scientists to identify sequences and to record what is known about them. Many entries also record *conjectures*: patterns that the contributor observed in the data but could not prove.

This paper is about entry A380060 [1], contributed by Paul D. Hanna in February 2025. It reads:

> `G.f. A(x) satisfies A(x) = Sum_{n=-oo..+oo} x^(n^2) * (A(x) - x^n)^n/(1 - x^n*A(x))^n.`
>
> `The term x^(n^2) * (A - x^n)^n/(1 - x^n*A)^n is invariant under sign reversal of n.`

— OEIS A380060, Paul D. Hanna, February 2025

Here "G.f." stands for *generating function*: the series $A(x) = \sum_{n\geq 0} a(n)\, x^n$ whose coefficients are the terms of the sequence, and `Sum_{n=-oo..+oo}` is a sum over all integers n. So A is defined *implicitly*: it appears on both sides of its own equation. Using the symmetry noted in the entry, the sum over all integers can be folded into a sum over the positive integers (Lemma 2.1 below), and the definition becomes

$$A = 1 + 2\,\Sigma(A), \qquad \text{where} \qquad \Sigma(A) = \sum_{j\geq 1} x^{j^2} \Big(\frac{A - x^j}{1 - x^j A}\Big)^j. \tag{1}$$

This one-sided form is formula (2) of the entry, and it is the definition we work with. Lemma 4.1 shows that it determines A completely.

The first terms, starting at $n = 0$, are 1, 2, 4, 16, 66, 284, 1256, 5752, 26944, 128538, 622560, 3053224, 15132720, 75679956, ...

The sum in the definition looks like the classical *theta series* $\theta(x) = \sum_n x^{n^2} = 1 + 2x + 2x^4 + 2x^9 + \cdots$ (Section 2), except that each term x^{n^2} carries an extra factor. We call such sums *theta-type sums*. A companion entry by the same author, OEIS A380680 [2], contributed on the same day, defines a similar series, with the constant 2 in place of A inside the sum, and states the same conjecture word for word. For that entry the conjecture is false; it is treated in a companion paper in the same collection [9].

1.2 The question

The entry contains the following conjecture.

> `Conjecture: for n > 0, a(n) == 2 (mod 4) iff n is a square, and a(n) is divisible by 4 when n is nonsquare.`
>
> — OEIS A380060, Paul D. Hanna, February 2025

Here `a(n) == 2 (mod 4)` means that $a(n)$ leaves remainder 2 on division by 4. So, for $n > 0$, the conjecture says that $a(n)$ has remainder 2 modulo 4 when n is a perfect square $1, 4, 9, 16, \ldots$, and remainder 0 otherwise. The table shows the remainders of the first 48 terms. The indices in bold are the perfect squares.

n	0	**1**	2	3	**4**	5	6	7	8	**9**	10	11	12	13	14	15
$a(n)$ mod 4	1	**2**	0	0	**2**	0	0	0	0	**2**	0	0	0	0	0	0
n	**16**	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	**25**	26	27	28	29	30	31
$a(n)$ mod 4	**2**	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	**2**	0	0	0	0	0	0
n	32	33	34	35	**36**	37	38	39	40	41	42	43	44	45	46	47
$a(n)$ mod 4	0	0	0	0	**2**	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

1.3 What this paper proves

Main result (Theorem 3.1). *The conjecture is true. In fact every coefficient of A has the same remainder modulo 4 as the corresponding coefficient of the theta series:*

$$A(x) \equiv \theta(x) = 1 + 2\sum_{j\geq 1} x^{j^2} \pmod 4.$$

The proof needs two observations. First, modulo 2 the equation says simply $A \equiv 1$, because the sum is multiplied by 2. Second, when 1 is put in place of A, each factor $(A - x^j)/(1 - x^j A)$ becomes $(1 - x^j)/(1 - x^j) = 1$, and the sum turns into the theta series itself.

1.4 What was known

The entry records the folded form of the sum (its formula (2), our equation (2)) and two further rewritings of it. Vaclav Kotesovec added an asymptotic formula for the size of $a(n)$. We are not aware of an earlier proof or disproof of the conjecture.

1.5 Why it is interesting

The theta series is a central object of number theory, and Hanna's sums are deformations of it: each term x^{n^2} is multiplied by a complicated factor. One may ask how much of the arithmetic of the theta series survives the deformation. For the remainders modulo 4 the answer turns out to be simple: modulo 4, Hanna's sums are again theta series (Section 6). The two companion entries also make a useful pair of examples. They look almost the same, their conjectures are stated in the same words, and yet the conjecture is true for A380060 and false for A380680. The proofs show exactly where the difference comes from.

1.6 How to read this paper

Section 2 explains the few notions we need: power series, remainders, the theta series, and how to make sense of a sum over all integers. Section 3 states the results precisely, and Section 4 proves them; the proofs are short. Section 5 describes how the results were checked, by computer and by a formal proof in Lean. Section 6 discusses the scope of the result and a generalization.

2 Background

This section collects the definitions and facts used later. Readers who know formal power series and congruences can skip it and return when needed.

2.1 Power series as bookkeeping

A *formal power series* is a way of storing an infinite sequence of numbers $u_0, u_1, u_2, \ldots$ in one object,

$$U(x) = u_0 + u_1 x + u_2 x^2 + u_3 x^3 + \cdots .$$

The letter x is only a placeholder that keeps the terms apart. We never substitute a number for x, so the question of whether the series "converges" never arises; a power series is simply its list of coefficients. We write $[x^n]\,U = u_n$ for the coefficient of x^n in U. Two series are equal when all their coefficients are equal.

Series are added coefficient by coefficient and multiplied like polynomials:

$$[x^n]\,(UV) = u_0 v_n + u_1 v_{n-1} + \cdots + u_n v_0.$$

Each coefficient of a product is a finite sum, so everything is well defined. For example, $(1 - x)(1 + x + x^2 + x^3 + \cdots) = 1$, because all the other terms cancel. So $1 + x + x^2 + \cdots$ is the

multiplicative inverse of $1-x$, and we write it as $\frac{1}{1-x}$. In the same way, every series D whose constant term is 1 has exactly one multiplicative inverse $\frac{1}{D}$. Its coefficients can be computed one at a time from $D \cdot \frac{1}{D} = 1$, using only additions, subtractions and multiplications. Every fraction in this paper has a denominator of this kind, so it stands for an honest power series.

Two more pieces of notation. We write $U = O(x^d)$ when all coefficients of U below degree d are zero. So $U - V = O(x^d)$ means that U and V agree up to degree $d-1$. A series of the form $x + u_2x^2 + u_3x^3 + \cdots$, with constant term 0 and coefficient of x equal to 1, is called *normalized*.

2.2 Remainders and congruences

For an integer $m \geq 2$ we write $a \equiv b \pmod{m}$ ("a is congruent to b modulo m") when $a - b$ is divisible by m, that is, when a and b leave the same remainder after division by m. For example, $17 \equiv 5 \pmod{4}$, since both leave remainder 1, and $-3 \equiv 1 \pmod{4}$. The remainder of a on division by m is called its *residue* modulo m; it is one of $0, 1, \ldots, m-1$. Saying that a is odd is the same as saying $a \equiv 1 \pmod{2}$.

Residues can be added and multiplied consistently, as on a clock. The residues $0, 1, \ldots, m-1$ with this "clock arithmetic" form a number system written $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$. When $m = p$ is a prime we also write $\mathbb{F}_p$. In $\mathbb{F}_2 = \{0, 1\}$ we have $1 + 1 = 0$, so adding and subtracting are the same thing.

For power series with integer coefficients, $U \equiv V \pmod{m}$ means that *every* coefficient of $U - V$ is divisible by m. Equivalently, the two series become equal when every coefficient is replaced by its residue; we call this *reducing* the series modulo m. The key fact is simple:

Reduction modulo m is compatible with all the operations above. To reduce a sum, a product, a substitution, or an inverse, we may reduce the ingredients first and then compute with clock arithmetic. This holds because every coefficient of the result is obtained from finitely many coefficients of the ingredients by adding, subtracting and multiplying, and these operations are compatible with remainders.

A word on "rings". Several lemmas below hold not only for integers, but in every number system in which one can add, subtract and multiply with the usual rules (such as $\mathbb{Z}$, $\mathbb{Q}$, and $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$). Mathematicians call such a number system a *commutative ring*. We use the word only in this sense. No division is ever needed, which matters because in $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ one cannot always divide (for instance, 2 has no inverse in $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$).

2.3 The theta series

The *theta series* is the power series

$$\theta(x) = \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} x^{n^2} = 1 + 2x + 2x^4 + 2x^9 + 2x^{16} + \cdots .$$

The sum runs over all integers n: positive, negative and zero. The terms for n and $-n$ are equal, and $n = 0$ gives 1, so

$$\theta(x) = 1 + 2\sum_{j \geq 1} x^{j^2}.$$

So the coefficient of x^n in θ is the number of integers whose square is n: it is 1 for $n = 0$, it is 2 when n is a positive perfect square (the two square roots $\pm j$), and it is 0 otherwise. In particular, for $n > 0$ the coefficient of x^n in $\theta(x)$ is 2 if n is a square and 0 if it is not.

Replacing x by x^2 gives $\theta(x^2) = 1 + 2\sum_{j\ge1} x^{2j^2} = 1 + 2x^2 + 2x^8 + 2x^{18} + \cdots$, whose nonzero coefficients sit at twice the squares.

The theta series goes back to Jacobi, and it is one of the basic objects of number theory. For example, the coefficient of x^n in $\theta(x)^k$ is the number of ways to write n as a sum of k squares of integers, counting order and signs; see [3].

2.4 The two-sided sum

Hanna's definitions are sums over all integers n, and for negative n the terms contain negative powers of x. To make sense of them we use *formal Laurent series*: series that may also contain finitely many negative powers of x, such as $x^{-2} + 3 + x + x^2 + \cdots$. They are added and multiplied like power series. With rational coefficients, every nonzero Laurent series has a multiplicative inverse: write it as $c\,x^{-k}(1 + \cdots)$ with $c \neq 0$ and invert each factor (the factor $1 + \cdots$ has constant term 1, so it can be inverted as in the previous subsection).

For a power series U and an integer $j \ge 1$ we write

$$Q_j(U) = \frac{U - x^j}{1 - x^j U}.$$

The denominator has constant term 1, so $Q_j(U)$ is an honest power series, and it has integer coefficients if U has.

Lemma 2.1 (Folding the sum)**.** *Let U be a power series with rational coefficients and nonzero constant term. For every $j \ge 1$, the term with index $n = -j$ of the sum $\sum_n x^{n^2}\big((U - x^n)/(1 - x^n U)\big)^n$ is equal to the term with index $n = j$:*

$$x^{j^2}\Big(\frac{U - x^{-j}}{1 - x^{-j}U}\Big)^{-j} = x^{j^2}\,Q_j(U)^j.$$

Consequently the two-sided sum is a power series, and

$$\sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} x^{n^2}\Big(\frac{U - x^n}{1 - x^n U}\Big)^n = 1 + 2\,\Sigma(U), \qquad \text{where} \qquad \Sigma(U) = \sum_{j\ge1} x^{j^2}\,Q_j(U)^j. \tag{2}$$

Proof. Both $U - x^{-j}$ and $1 - x^{-j}U$ are nonzero Laurent series (the first contains the term $-x^{-j}$, and the second is not zero because U has a constant term and so is not x^j), so the fraction and its inverse make sense. A negative exponent means: invert, then raise to the power j. So the left side is

$$x^{j^2}\Big(\frac{1 - x^{-j}U}{U - x^{-j}}\Big)^j = x^{j^2}\Big(\frac{x^j - U}{x^j U - 1}\Big)^j = x^{j^2}\Big(\frac{U - x^j}{1 - x^j U}\Big)^j,$$

where we multiplied the numerator and the denominator by x^j, and then changed the sign of both. The term with $n = 0$ is 1. Pairing $n = j$ with $n = -j$ gives (2). Finally, the term with index j is x^{j^2} times a power series, so only the finitely many j with $j^2 \le n$ affect the coefficient of x^n; this is why the infinite sum is a well-defined power series. □

The OEIS entry notes the symmetry of Lemma 2.1 ("invariant under sign reversal of n") and records the folded form as its formula (2). In the one-sided form no negative powers and no division occur, so it makes sense with coefficients in any number system, including the clock arithmetic $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$.

2.5 Doubling modulo 4

Lemma 2.2. *Let U and V be power series with integer coefficients. If $U \equiv V \pmod 2$, then $2U \equiv 2V \pmod 4$.*

Proof. Every coefficient of $U - V$ is even, so every coefficient of $2U - 2V = 2(U - V)$ is divisible by 4. □

In words: *to know twice a series modulo* 4*, it is enough to know the series modulo* 2. The sums in question are multiplied by 2, and this is what makes the proofs below so short.

3 Results

Theorem 3.1. *Equation* (1) *has exactly one solution A among the power series with integer coefficients, and*

$$A(x) \equiv \theta(x) = 1 + 2\sum_{j \geq 1} x^{j^2} \pmod 4.$$

Consequently, for every $n > 0$:

- *$a(n) \equiv 2 \pmod 4$ if n is a perfect square, and*
- *$a(n)$ is divisible by 4 if n is not a perfect square.*

This is exactly Hanna's conjecture.

4 Proofs

The idea in brief. Modulo 2, the equation $A = 1 + 2\Sigma(A)$ says $A \equiv 1$. Putting 1 in place of A turns every factor $(A - x^j)/(1 - x^j A)$ into 1, so $\Sigma(A) \equiv \sum_{j \geq 1} x^{j^2} \pmod 2$. Since $\Sigma(A)$ appears multiplied by 2, knowing it modulo 2 is enough to know A modulo 4 (Lemma 2.2).

We first check that the equation has exactly one solution, in every number system, so that we may compute with it modulo 2.

Lemma 4.1. *In every commutative ring, equation* (1) *has exactly one solution A, and its constant term is* 1*. Reducing the integer solution modulo m gives the solution over $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$.*

Proof. We show that the coefficient of x^n on the right-hand side of (1) depends only on the coefficients of A below degree n. Then the equation determines A one coefficient at a time. The constant term is 1, because every term of $\Sigma(A)$ contains a factor x^{j^2} with $j \geq 1$. Each later coefficient is computed from the earlier ones by additions, subtractions and multiplications. This gives exactly one solution in every commutative ring. Reduction modulo m is compatible with these operations, so it maps the integer solution to the solution over $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$.

So suppose that two series U and V agree below degree r, that is, $U - V = O(x^r)$. Then the numerators $U - x^j$ and $V - x^j$ agree below degree r, and so do the denominators $D = 1 - x^j U$ and $E = 1 - x^j V$. Their inverses also agree below degree r, because $\frac{1}{D} - \frac{1}{E} = \frac{E-D}{DE}$. Products of series that agree below degree r again agree below degree r (since $UW - VZ = U(W - Z) + (U - V)Z$), so $Q_j(U)^j$ and $Q_j(V)^j$ agree below degree r. After multiplication by x^{j^2}, with $j^2 \geq 1$, they agree below degree $r + 1$. Hence $\Sigma(U)$ and $\Sigma(V)$ agree below degree $r + 1$. Taking $r = n$ gives the claim. □

Proof of Theorem 3.1. By Lemma 4.1, the reduction of A modulo 2 is the solution of (1) over $\mathbb{F}_2$. In $\mathbb{F}_2$ the number 2 is 0, so there the equation reads $A = 1$. Hence

$$A \equiv 1 \pmod 2.$$

Reduction modulo 2 is compatible with all the operations in Σ, so $\Sigma(A) \equiv \Sigma(1) \pmod 2$. And $\Sigma(1)$ is easy to compute: $Q_j(1) = (1 - x^j)/(1 - x^j) = 1$ for every j, so

$$\Sigma(A) \equiv \Sigma(1) = \sum_{j \geq 1} x^{j^2} \pmod 2.$$

By Lemma 2.2, multiplying by 2 gives $2\Sigma(A) \equiv 2\sum_{j\geq 1} x^{j^2} \pmod 4$, and therefore

$$A = 1 + 2\Sigma(A) \equiv 1 + 2\sum_{j \geq 1} x^{j^2} = \theta(x) \pmod 4.$$

Finally, we read off the coefficients. Different $j \geq 1$ give different squares j^2, so for $n > 0$ the coefficient of x^n in $\theta(x)$ is 2 when n is a perfect square and 0 otherwise. Hence $a(n) \equiv 2 \pmod 4$ for the squares, and $a(n) \equiv 0 \pmod 4$, that is, 4 divides $a(n)$, for all other $n > 0$. □

5 Checking the results

A mathematical proof can contain mistakes, so the results were checked in two independent ways.

Numerical check. We solved equation (1) by repeated substitution, with exact integer arithmetic. The result reproduces all 27 terms printed in the OEIS entry. It also satisfies the original two-sided equation up to the term x^{219}, with the terms for negative n computed directly as Laurent series rather than by folding. The pattern of Theorem 3.1 holds for every $0 < n < 220$. The computation was done with the PARI/GP computer algebra system, using code that was written separately from the formal proofs (file `verification/independent_checks.gp` in the accompanying repository [9]). A computation can only test finitely many cases, so it is a check on the definitions and on the indexing, not a proof.

Formal proof in Lean. Lean [7] is a *proof assistant*: a program in which mathematical statements and their proofs are written in a precise formal language, and every step is checked mechanically down to the basic rules of logic. All results of this paper are proved in Lean 4 (version 4.19.0) on top of Mathlib [8], Lean's library of formalized mathematics. The statements are collected in the file `lean/Entries/A380060.lean` of the repository, in the namespace `FinalCollection.A380060`. There the one-sided sum $\Sigma(A)$ is written out coefficient by coefficient (only the indices $j \leq n$ can contribute to x^n), and the multiplicative inverse of a series with constant term 1 is written `unitInv`. The folding of the two-sided sum (Lemma 2.1) is proved in this paper but not in Lean. The proofs are in the file `lean/Round4/ThetaRational.lean`. The table lists where each result of this paper is proved.

Statement in this paper	Lean theorem(s)
Lemma 4.1 over $\mathbb{Z}$: equation (1) has exactly one solution	`implicit_source_exists_unique`
The sequence satisfies (1), coefficient by coefficient	`implicit_actual_source`
Theorem 3.1: $A \equiv \theta(x) \pmod 4$	`complete_series_mod_four`
Theorem 3.1: the two statements for each $n > 0$	`a380060_statement`

The Lean project was rebuilt from source for this paper, and Lean was asked to list the basic assumptions (axioms) that each of these theorems ultimately depends on. Every one depends only on the three standard axioms of Lean's logic (`propext`, `Classical.choice`, `Quot.sound`); no step is left unproved. A formal proof certifies exactly the statement that Lean checks. Whether that statement says what the OEIS entry means is a separate question, so the Lean definitions were also compared, side by side, with the definition in the OEIS entry (Section 1.1).

6 Discussion

Scope. Theorem 3.1 settles the conjecture completely: it gives the remainder of every coefficient modulo 4. It does not extend to modulo 8. For example $a(2) = 4$, while the coefficient of x^2 in $\theta(x)$ is 0. We have not studied the remainders modulo 8, and the theorem says nothing about the size of $a(n)$, which is described by Kotesovec's asymptotic formula in the entry.

The companion entry. In OEIS A380680 the series A inside the sum is replaced by the constant 2. Modulo 2 this changes the factor $(U - x^j)/(1 - x^j U)$ from 1 to x^j, and the remainders 2 move from the squares j^2 to the numbers $2j^2$. So the same conjecture, stated in that entry, is false there.

A general principle. The two proofs are instances of one observation. Reduction modulo 2 is compatible with all the operations in $\Sigma(U)$, so $\Sigma(U)$ modulo 2 depends only on U modulo 2. By Lemma 2.2, *the remainder of* $1 + 2\Sigma(U)$ *modulo* 4 *depends only on the remainder of* U *modulo* 2. In particular, for every integer series U:

- if $U \equiv 1 \pmod 2$ (odd constant term, all other coefficients even), then $1 + 2\Sigma(U) \equiv \theta(x) \pmod 4$, because $Q_j(1) = 1$;
- if $U \equiv 0 \pmod 2$ (all coefficients even), then $1 + 2\Sigma(U) \equiv \theta(x^2) \pmod 4$, because $Q_j(0) = -x^j$ and $x^{j^2}(-x^j)^j = \pm x^{2j^2}$.

A380060 is the first case with $U = A$ and A380680 is the second case with $U = 2$. We tested both cases numerically on a few other choices of U; this general remark is not part of the Lean formalization.

The method. The proofs illustrate a principle used throughout this collection of papers: a sequence defined by an equation between power series often becomes simple after reduction modulo a small number, and the simple form can be found by a short calculation and then checked.

About this paper

How the work was done. This paper is one of 34 papers on conjectures from the OEIS that came out of an autonomous AI research effort directed by Dev D. Goyal [9]. The roles were as follows.

- *Dev D. Goyal* started the project, chose which problems to pursue, asked for proofs, formal verification and revisions, and decided what to publish. Dev D. Goyal did not supply proof strategies or intermediate arguments.

- *ChatGPT* (OpenAI), using the GPT-6 model with Pro reasoning, worked autonomously from those prompts. It searched the OEIS for suitable conjectures, found the proofs, wrote the Lean 4 formalization, and wrote a first draft of this paper.
- *Claude Opus 5.5*, used with Claude Code, checked the work independently and then rewrote this paper. It rebuilt the Lean project from source and confirmed that the theorems listed in Section 5 rely only on Lean's standard axioms; compared the Lean definitions with the OEIS definition; recomputed the sequence with separately written PARI/GP code, compared it with the terms published in the OEIS, and tested every claim of the paper on many terms; and read every step of the proofs. It then rewrote the text to make it self-contained and readable. The theorems and the proof strategies are ChatGPT's. In rewriting, Claude Opus 5.5 expanded the explanations and, in places, wrote out an argument in more detail or by a more elementary route. The Discussion section was written during this rewrite; the further observations it contains were checked by computer, and they are not part of the Lean formalization.

Dev D. Goyal has verified the results and is responsible for this paper.

Review status. This paper has not been peer reviewed, and it has not been submitted to a journal or to the OEIS.

Priority. An OEIS entry that labels a statement as a conjecture shows only that its contributor did not know a proof; it does not show that no proof existed. During the research only limited searches for earlier work were made. No claim of priority is made.

Corrections. Please report any error in the issue tracker of the repository [9], where the Lean sources, the numerical checks, and the earlier drafts are also available.

Acknowledgements

The sequence and the conjecture are due to Paul D. Hanna [1], who also contributed the companion entry A380680 [2]. The asymptotic formula mentioned in the introduction was added to the entry by Vaclav Kotesovec.

References

[1] P. D. Hanna, entry A380060 (G.f. $A(x)$ satisfies $A(x) = \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} x^{n^2}(A(x) - x^n)^n/(1 - x^n A(x))^n$), *The On-Line Encyclopedia of Integer Sequences*, February 2025. `https://oeis.org/A380060`. Text as of October 2026.

[2] P. D. Hanna, entry A380680 (G.f. $A(x) = \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} x^{n^2}(2 - x^n)^n/(1 - 2x^n)^n$), *The On-Line Encyclopedia of Integer Sequences*, February 2025. `https://oeis.org/A380680`. Text as of October 2026.

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[9] D. D. Goyal, *Proofs and corrections for 34 OEIS entries, with Lean 4 formalizations*, repository, 2026. `https://github.com/dvgyl/oeis-a396843-proof`.